DESIGNER HANDOFF · APRIL 2026

UX RECOMMENDATIONS FOR EXISTING PAGES

Fifty page-level + eight cross-page UX recommendations for the pages already covered by the original PDF design set. These are **improvements to existing surfaces** — separate from the off-spec inventory of net-new features. Read each as a small design brief: title, take, why-it-matters, importance, heuristic.

AUDIT BY
Jerick Evans · UX Designer · Tech Fleet · Phase 4

SOURCE
audit/recommendations.json

TOTAL RECOMMENDATIONS
50 page-level + 8 cross-page

PAGES COVERED
15 PDF-source pages

HEURISTIC KEY

- **EMERGENCY** Find & act in 3 seconds, one-handed, on mobile
- **RESPONSIVE** Holds up at 375 / 768 / 1280 / 1440
- **ERRORS** Form failures, offline, recovery paths
- **ACCESSIBILITY** WCAG 2.1 AA — alt, focus, contrast, hierarchy
- **EMOTIONAL** Brand voice, trust, micro-copy
- **DISCOVERY** Search, filters, wayfinding

5 Users likely abandon without it · 4 High-impact UX gap · 3 Moderate improvement · 2 Polish · 1 Nice-to-have

IN THIS DOCUMENT

01	Landing	4 RECS
02	About Us	4 RECS
03	Contact	3 RECS
04	Donate	1 REC
05	Newsletter	4 RECS
06	Newsletter article	3 RECS
07	Programs	4 RECS
08	Seasonal Camps detail	5 RECS
09	Private Lessons detail	3 RECS
10	Log in	4 RECS
11	Sign up	2 RECS
12	Payment	4 RECS
13	Profile	3 RECS
14	Preferences	3 RECS
15	Class History	3 RECS
16	Cross-page	8 RECS

01 LANDING

index.html **4** RECS

4 HERO CAROUSEL NEEDS SPOKEN STATUS UPDATES

ACCESSIBILITY

Make the carousel narrate itself — parents on assistive tech are missing featured programs.

The hero rotates through four featured programs but a screen reader sees a static image. Parents using VoiceOver or TalkBack don't know the slide changed. Adding aria-live announcements ("Slide 2 of 4: Seasonal Camps") puts everyone on the same footing during program discovery.

4 TODAY'S CLASSES NEED VISUAL URGENCY CUES

EMERGENCY

Distinguish full from filling-fast at a glance — parents are deciding in 3 seconds.

Right now every time-slot looks equally available. A parent scrolling at school pickup wants to know which class is filling fast and which is open. A small enrollment badge or coloured pill (Open · Filling · Full) earns its keep here.

3 DONOR TESTIMONIALS NEED VERIFICATION CONTEXT

EMOTIONAL

A name and a quote isn't enough. Show why this person is credible.

Major donors land on the home page first and judge organisational stewardship from quotes within seconds. Adding a small verified marker (years supported, or "Donor since 2022") signals these are real humans, not stock copy.

3 MAKE ENROLMENT THE LOUD CTA ON MOBILE

EMERGENCY

Donate is shouting at the same volume as Enrol. Quiet one of them.

Most homepage traffic is parents with kids in tow, not donors. Right now Donate and Enrol carry equal visual weight on mobile, which fragments intent. Demoting Donate to a secondary CTA (text link or outline button) on small screens lets parents find the path they came for.

02 ABOUT US

about.html 4 RECS

4 SUCCESS-STORIES CAROUSEL DOESN'T WORK WITHOUT A MOUSE

ACCESSIBILITY

If your trackpad-less colleague can't read the testimonials, neither can a screen-reader user.

The horizontal carousel lacks Previous / Next buttons that work via keyboard. Visible arrow controls with focus rings let everyone — keyboard users, low-vision users, screen readers — get through the stories.

3 VALUES GRID FEELS LIKE A CORPORATE REPORT ON MOBILE

EMOTIONAL

Three abstract value statements stacked vertically is a wall of text. Add an emotional anchor.

Kids ages 6–18 do see this page (parents bring them along during decisions). Pairing each value with one illustrative photo or a child's quote makes the values feel like a story, not a brand pillar slide.

3 LEADERSHIP NAMES WITHOUT ROLE CONTEXT = WASTED REAL ESTATE

EMERGENCY

Yasmine, Dolores — who? Adults assessing credibility scroll for context.

Headshots without roles read as "meet the team" filler. A single line under each name ("Executive Director · 12 years in Queens arts ed") lets parents and donors do a one-pass credibility check without scrolling.

2 NEWSLETTER SIGNUP HIDES THE VALUE EXCHANGE

EMOTIONAL

Tell people what they're getting before asking for their email.

Right now the form just says "Subscribe". One sentence — "Weekly notes from the studio: class highlights, photos from showcases, and the occasional behind-the-scenes" — gives parents the trust signal they need to opt in.

03 CONTACT

contact.html **3** RECS

5 PHONE NUMBER NEEDS TO BE THE LOUDEST THING ON THIS PAGE

EMERGENCY

If a parent's child forgot pickup time, they don't fill out a form — they call.

Contact-us moments are often time-sensitive (forgot pickup, allergy concern, late drop-off). The phone number should be the first thing visible, with a prominent treatment — large display type or a tap-to-call button on mobile — not a list item alongside email and address.

3 FORM ERRORS SHOULD ANNOUNCE THEMSELVES ABOVE THE FOLD

ERRORS

A parent who just hit Send and saw nothing happen will leave.

Inline field errors are easy to miss, especially after a submission attempt scrolls the form out of view. A summary box at the top of the form on submission failure ("Please check 2 fields below") gives clear feedback and disables the submit button until corrections are made.

2 FAQ CHEVRONS NEED A VISIBLE OPEN/CLOSED STATE

ACCESSIBILITY

Keyboard users tabbing through FAQs can't tell which one is open.

The native details/summary element handles state correctly but the visual treatment doesn't reinforce it strongly. A clear chevron rotation and a focus ring make the interaction legible to keyboard and low-vision users.

04 DONATE

`donate.html` **1** REC

4 DONATION AMOUNTS NEED IMPACT ANCHORING

EMOTIONAL

$50 is just a number. "$50 = a semester of dance for one child" is a decision.

Preset amount buttons currently look like radio options. Adding a one-line impact statement under each ($25 = supplies for a workshop · $50 = a semester for one child · $250 = a private lesson series for a kid on scholarship) turns abstract dollars into concrete outcomes.

05 NEWSLETTER

newsletter.html

4 RECS

3 TABS COLLAPSE POORLY ON MOBILE

RESPONSIVE

Home / Saved / Read Later / Get Involved truncates and the active tab gets lost.

Equal-width tab buttons cram together at 375px. Either go to a horizontal scroll-snap row with one fully-visible active tab, or collapse to a select dropdown on mobile so the user sees their current section clearly.

3 EMPTY-SEARCH STATE IS INVISIBLE

ERRORS

Articles disappear with no explanation — looks like the page broke.

When the filter returns zero matches, the grid silently empties. Add a centred "No articles match 'jazz'" state with a Clear-Search button. Reassures users that the system is working and gives them a clear way out.

3 BOOKMARK STATE NEEDS A SYNC INDICATOR

ERRORS

Bookmarks live in localStorage today. If a parent expects them on their other device, they'll be disappointed.

Right now there's no signal that bookmarks are device-local. Either show a small "Saved locally" badge with a "Sign in to sync" CTA, or commit to syncing post-Shopify and show pending state during the round trip.

2 RELATED-NEWSLETTERS CARDS HAVE STINGY TAP AREAS

ACCESSIBILITY

Make the whole card clickable, not just the title link.

On mobile a kid (or a thumb-fumbling adult) is going to miss-tap. Wrapping the entire card in the anchor — title, image, summary — gives a 250px+ tap target that matches the iOS/Android guidelines.

06 NEWSLETTER ARTICLE

newsletter-article.html

3 RECS

2 DROP CAP SHOULD NOT BE READ OUT TWICE

ACCESSIBILITY

Screen readers can announce the drop-cap letter as a separate element. Hide it from them.

If the article's first paragraph starts with a styled drop cap built via ::first-letter or a wrapper span, ensure the styled letter is `aria-hidden` and the actual paragraph reads naturally. Otherwise low-vision users hear "T. The dance studio is...".

2 SHARE / SAVE / PRINT ICONS NEED TEXT LABELS AT ALL SIZES

RESPONSIVE

Three icons with no text is a guess on mobile.

Even small icons should carry visible labels at common reading distances. Stack the label under the icon at all viewports, or make this a button bar with text + icon. Cuts confusion between Save (bookmark) vs Print.

2 PULL-QUOTES DON'T READ AS PULL-QUOTES

EMERGENCY

A grey left border isn't enough — it just looks like indented text.

A bigger typography step, a tinted background, or a leading quote-mark glyph turns a blockquote into the visual breath the article needs. Right now they slip past in a scan.

07 PROGRAMS

programs.html

4 RECS

4 ENROLMENT STATUS NEEDS COLOUR, NOT JUST TEXT

EMERGENCY

"3 spots left" is the difference between buying now and waiting. Make it shout.

Current implementation displays capacity as plain text. Add a coloured pill (green = open, amber = filling, red = full or waitlist) plus an enrolment-percent bar in the card. Parents scan dozens of cards; visual shorthand wins.

3 FILTER CHIPS NEED A CLEARER SELECTED STATE

EMERGENCY

aria-pressed is great for screen readers but invisible to eyes.

When a parent taps Dance, the chip should change visually — solid fill, contrasted text — not just announce the change to assistive tech. Two-state styling (light unselected, brand-coloured selected) gives instant feedback.

3 EMPTY FILTER RESULTS NEED A RECOVERY MESSAGE

ERRORS

Cards just vanish — the parent thinks they broke the page.

When chip + search combine to zero results, render an inviting "Nothing matches yet — try clearing filters or browsing Coming Soon" with a Clear-Filters button. Turns a dead end into a path forward.

3 PARENT TESTIMONIALS NEED A VERIFIED MARKER

EMOTIONAL

Stock-looking quotes lose readers. Show this parent's kid is in the program.

A small "Parent of Story Jazz student, 2024" line under each quote — with a verified checkmark — lifts these from copywriting to social proof. Especially important for a small nonprofit competing with big-brand studios.

08 SEASONAL CAMPS DETAIL

`seasonal-camps.html` **5** RECS

4 STICKY SIDEBAR COLLIDES WITH CONTENT ON MOBILE

RESPONSIVE

On a phone the sticky sidebar covers the section it's meant to navigate to.

Convert the sidebar to a non-sticky table-of-contents card at the top of the page on mobile, or to a collapsible drawer triggered by a tap. Otherwise scrolling to FAQs hides the FAQ heading behind the nav.

4 THE THREE THINGS PARENTS NEED FIRST ARE BURIED

EMERGENCY

Capacity, price, dates. Surface them above the fold.

A parent comparing camps does a 3-second pass for: when, how much, are there spots. Right now those facts live in a sidebar card mid-page. Promote them to a Quick Facts strip directly under the hero so the page rewards a quick scan.

3 INSTRUCTOR CARDS NEED A TEACHING PHILOSOPHY LINE

EMERGENCY

Patient & playful vs. rigorous & precise — parents pick a fit, not a credential.

A photo and a name doesn't help a parent who's trying to figure out if this teacher is right for their nervous 8-year-old. One sentence of pedagogy under the name ("Patient, movement-first, builds confidence over technique") earns trust faster than a degree list.

3 STUDIO LOCATION SVG IS INVISIBLE TO SCREEN READERS

ACCESSIBILITY

The pin icon needs to speak the address.

Decorative SVGs need an aria-label or wrapping link so the address is reachable from assistive tech. Without it, a low-vision parent can't locate the studio without manual copy/paste of the text address.

2 EXPANDED FAQ SHOULD SCROLL INTO VIEW

RESPONSIVE

Tapping the bottom FAQ on a phone hides the answer.

On mobile, opening a details/summary panel near the bottom of the viewport doesn't scroll the answer into view. A short scrollIntoView({behavior: smooth, block: nearest}) on toggle solves it.

09 PRIVATE LESSONS DETAIL

`private-lessons.html` **3** RECS

4 SHOW AVAILABLE TIME SLOTS IN-PAGE

EMERGENCY

Asynchronous "contact us to check" friction kills bookings.

Even a read-only calendar of available slots (greyed-out booked, highlighted available) sets expectations and lets parents self-qualify before they reach out. After Shopify go-live this becomes a real-time booking widget.

3 TELL PARENTS HOW INSTRUCTOR MATCHING WORKS

EMOTIONAL

"How We Match You" answers the question parents are afraid to ask.

Private lessons are a higher-trust, higher-cost commitment. The page should say plainly: do parents request an instructor, do staff match, can they switch? A short How-We-Match-You section reduces enrolment hesitation.

3 SHOW PACKAGE TIERS, NOT A SINGLE PRICE

EMERGENCY

4 lessons or 8? Save how much? Don't make the parent calculate.

A simple comparison table (4 lessons / 8 lessons / 12 lessons with the per-lesson rate at each tier) lets parents commit at the right level without doing math.

10 LOG IN

login.html **4** RECS

3 ROLE TOGGLE NEEDS A ONE-LINER EXPLANATION

EMERGENCY

Student / Parent or Donor — what's the difference and why does it matter?

First-time users may pick the wrong role and end up in the wrong dashboard. A short caption under the toggle ("Parents enrol kids and view schedules. Donors manage contributions.") prevents the confusion and the support ticket.

3 PASSWORD REVEAL ICON FAILS CONTRAST

ACCESSIBILITY

The eye icon disappears against the input on some breakpoints.

Make sure the toggle's icon meets the WCAG AA 4.5:1 minimum against the input background — particularly important for parents using glasses to enter a long password.

2 SOCIAL-LOGIN BUTTONS NEED TEXT LABELS

EMERGENCY

Three icons in a row is a memory test, not a UI.

"Continue with Google" / "Continue with Apple" / "Continue with Email" — full text labels — convert better than icons alone, especially with older parents.

2 FORGOT PASSWORD NEEDS A HINT ABOUT WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

EMOTIONAL

Clicking the link is scary if you don't know whether it deletes your account.

A small caption ("We'll email you a reset link") underneath disambiguates. Also a confirmation toast after submission so users know the email was sent and can check their inbox.

11 SIGN UP

signup.html

2 RECS

3 SIGN-UP SUCCESS STATE IS MISSING

ERRORS

Did the form submit? The user has no idea.

After submitting, swap the form for a clear success panel: "We've sent a confirmation email to alex@example.com. Check your inbox to verify." Eliminates the "did it work?" double-tap that creates duplicate accounts.

2 FIRST / LAST NAME FIELDS CRAMP ON TABLET

RESPONSIVE

Two fields side-by-side at 768px = wrapped placeholder text.

Stack the name fields vertically below 900px wide. Names like "Maria-Jose Hernandez-Smith" don't fit comfortably in half a tablet width.

12 PAYMENT

payment.html

4 RECS

3 SWITCHING CARD → PAYPAL SHOULD CHANGE THE FORM VISIBLY

EMERGENCY

Right now selecting PayPal still shows card fields. Confusing.

Hide the card-specific fields when PayPal is selected (and reveal the PayPal CTA). Otherwise users fill in a card form they didn't intend to use, get confused on submit.

3 BILLING ADDRESS FIELDS SHOULD REFLOW BY COUNTRY

RESPONSIVE

State dropdown for someone in the UK is wrong (and embarrassing).

Country first, then conditionally render state/province / postal-code fields with the right label and validation for that country. Critical for international donors.

3 GENERIC IMPACT STATS MISS THE MOMENT

EMOTIONAL

"50K+ Lives Impacted" sounds corporate. Show what THIS donation does.

On the payment screen — the highest-emotion moment of the donor flow — replace generic stats with a personalised line: "Your $50 sponsors a semester of theatre for one student." Much harder to walk away from.

2 CVV NEEDS A TINY EXPLAINER

EMOTIONAL

Older parents skip the field because they don't know what it is.

A help icon next to CVV that shows a small "3-digit code on the back of your card" tooltip prevents abandonment. Every checkout team learns this eventually — get it right from the start.

13 PROFILE

`profile.html` **3** RECS

4 ACCOUNT SIDEBAR PUSHES CONTENT TOO FAR DOWN ON MOBILE

RESPONSIVE

On a phone, the sidebar takes up the entire viewport before content begins.

Convert the side nav to a slim tab bar across the top, or a collapsible drawer triggered by a hamburger. Saves a half-screen of mobile real estate.

3 CHILD PROFILE CARDS LACK EDIT / REMOVE

EMERGENCY

Today: parents have to call support to fix a typo in their kid's name.

Each child card needs Edit and Remove buttons. Self-service for typos, allergy updates, and de-enrolment when a child ages out. Reduces support load and frustration.

2 ACCOUNT SECURITY SECTION SHOULD SHOW 2FA STATUS AT A GLANCE

EMOTIONAL

Security settings without a status badge is an invitation to ignore them.

Beside each row (email, password, two-factor) show "Enabled" in green or "Set up" as a CTA. Lets users complete the security checklist without clicking through.

14 PREFERENCES

preferences.html

3 RECS

4 DELETE ACCOUNT NEEDS THE DESTRUCTIVE TREATMENT

ERRORS

A subtle button is the wrong UI for an irreversible action.

Distinct red styling, a confirmation modal that requires typing the word DELETE or the user's email, and a clear list of what gets erased (enrolment history, payment methods, child profiles). Standard pattern for a reason.

3 CRITICAL NOTIFICATION TOGGLES NEED CONFIRMATION

ERRORS

Accidental tap = parent stops getting class reminders. They miss class.

For high-impact notification toggles (class reminders, payment alerts), the first time a user disables them, show a small confirm dialog: "You'll stop receiving class reminders. Are you sure?" Saves the parent and the kid.

3 PHOTO / VIDEO CONSENT NEEDS CONTEXT-SPECIFIC TOGGLES

EMOTIONAL

Some parents are fine with internal records, not website features. Don't force all-or-nothing.

Split the consent into two toggles — "For internal class records" vs "For website / social media". Privacy-conscious parents shouldn't have to opt out of all photos to keep their kid off Instagram.

15 CLASS HISTORY

class-history.html

3 RECS

3 STATUS BADGES SHOULD NOT RELY ON COLOUR ALONE

ACCESSIBILITY

Colour-blind users can't distinguish Starting Soon from Closed.

Each badge needs a text label inside (Starting Soon · Active · Completed · Cancelled). Colour reinforces but never replaces.

3 CANCELLATION OUTCOME SHOULD BE EXPLICIT

ERRORS

Tapping Cancel and seeing nothing happen is terrifying for a parent.

After a confirmed cancellation: toast ("Class cancelled. Refund processed within 5 business days."), card visually moves to a Cancelled section, refund timeline shown. Three reassurances at once.

2 ACTION LINKS NEED A PRIMARY

EMERGENCY

View Details, View Receipt, Cancel, Report Issue — they all look equally important.

View Details is the primary action 90% of the time. Make it a button, demote the others to text-link secondary actions. Fewer choices = faster decisions.

CROSS-PAGE RECOMMENDATIONS

Patterns that show up on multiple pages and should be solved once with a shared component, not page-by-page.

5 QUICK-FACTS STRIP ON EVERY PROGRAM / COMMITMENT PAGE

EMERGENCY

Three-second scan: when, how much, are spots open. Nothing else first.

Index, Programs, Seasonal Camps, Private Lessons all need the same compact strip directly under the hero: dates, price (or down payment), capacity, age range. Same component, same position. Parents shouldn't relearn the page.

`index.html` `programs.html` `seasonal-camps.html` `private-lessons.html`

4 DEFINE ONE EMPTY-STATE PATTERN AND USE IT EVERYWHERE

ERRORS

Programs, Newsletter, Class History, Search — all silently empty. Pick one welcoming pattern.

Every list / grid / search across the site needs the same "no results" component: friendly headline, one suggestion, one Clear-Filter button. Not having this leaves four pages where users think the site broke.

`programs.html` `newsletter.html` `class-history.html` `search.html`

4 ONE TRUST-MARKER PATTERN FOR TESTIMONIALS AND CREDENTIALS

EMOTIONAL

If we can't verify it, why is it on the page?

Every testimonial — donor on the home page, parent on programs, leader on About — needs the same small verification cue (verified checkmark, role, year of involvement). Without it, the cumulative effect is "these are quotes from a marketing draft".

`index.html` `about.html` `programs.html`

4 STICKY SIDEBARS DON'T WORK ON MOBILE — PICK ONE COLLAPSE PATTERN

RESPONSIVE

Today the sidebar covers content on phones. Designers need to spec the small-screen behaviour.

Detail pages, account pages — multiple uses of the sticky sidebar pattern. Pick one — top tab strip, hamburger drawer, or non-sticky TOC card — and use it everywhere. The current inconsistency confuses navigation muscle memory.

`seasonal-camps.html` `private-lessons.html` `profile.html` `preferences.html`

4 SINGLE ACCESSIBLE-CAROUSEL PATTERN

ACCESSIBILITY

Every carousel today is a different a11y story. Pick one.

Hero on home, Success Stories on About, possibly more — all need: visible Previous/Next buttons (keyboard-reachable), aria-live on slide change, dot indicators with 24×24 hit targets. One spec, used everywhere.

`index.html` `about.html`

4 DESTRUCTIVE-ACTION PATTERN SITE-WIDE

ERRORS

Delete, Cancel, Remove — every one needs the same red, the same modal.

Account deletion, class cancellation, removing a payment method — same visual language: red CTA, confirmation modal, list of consequences. Standardising means users learn it once.

`preferences.html` `class-history.html` `payment.html`

3 SHOW SYNC STATUS ON EVERY AUTHENTICATED CHANGE

ERRORS

If the user just toggled something, tell them it saved.

Account preferences, child profiles, payment methods — every change today is silent. A small Saving… → Saved indicator (or a toast) consistently across all account pages eliminates the "did that work?" anxiety.

`profile.html` `preferences.html` `class-history.html` `payment.html`

3 ROLE CONTEXT EVERYWHERE ACCOUNT CREATION APPEARS

EMERGENCY

Student vs Donor isn't obvious. Tell people why it matters.

Login, signup, and any role-switch UI need the same one-line explanation: "Parents enrol kids and view class schedules. Donors manage contributions." One paragraph saves dozens of support tickets.

`login.html` `signup.html`